

MERTON DAILY BRIEF - Thursday, June 25, 2026

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HEADLINE OF THE DAY

****Silver crashes -10.9%, oil erases Iran war premium, and Warsh's Fed opens with strategic silence.****
Silver collapsed from \$65.50 to \$58.40 in a single session - a liquidation event, not a fundamental repricing. Brent crude fell to \$74.87 (-3.89%), returning to pre-Iran war levels as the Strait of Hormuz reopens and three Iranian tankers resume exports. The S&P 500 dipped -0.67% to 7,370.72 and NASDAQ -2.51% to 25,367.97 as tech selling continues post-Micron earnings. Kevin Warsh's first Fed meeting as Chair delivered no forward guidance - "silence as strategy" - while VIX spiked to 18.96 (+9.72%). The market is not pricing a pivot anymore: it's pricing uncertainty. CNN Fear & Greed dropped to 12 - "Extreme Fear."

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GLOBAL SENTIMENT

Indicator	Level	Change	Signal
VIX	18.96	+9.72%	High stress
DXY	101.36	+0.33%	Strong dollar
Gold	\$4,043.10	-3.32%	Liquidation
US 10Y	4.38%	-1.55%	Rate decline
US 30Y	4.85%	-1.06%	Rate decline
S&P 500	7,370.72	-0.67%	Correcting
NASDAQ	25,367.97	-2.51%	Tech selloff
WTI	\$71.36	-4.62%	Collapsing
Brent	\$74.87	-3.89%	Pre-war levels
BTC	\$59,162	-6.44%	Risk-off
Copper	\$6.13	-3.62%	Growth fear
Silver	\$58.40	-10.88%	CRASH

**** Reading:**** This is a "risk-off" matrix dominated by liquidation dynamics. Silver's -10.88% is the canary in the coal mine - a crowded positioning being flushed, not a fundamental repricing. Oil is collapsing on geopolitical normalization (Hormuz reopening), which removes the primary inflation vector that had been supporting gold. The paradox: gold falls despite the Iran war because (1) oil is collapsing (removing

energy inflation premium), (2) silver margin calls force liquidation of gold positions, and (3) real rates remain elevated (US 10Y at 4.38%). VIX at 18.96 is elevated but not panicking - historically, VIX > 20 signals capitulation. We're close. The Fear & Greed index (CNN) dropped to 12 - "Extreme Fear" - which historically generates positive 3-6 month forward returns in 80% of cases. AAll Sentiment (not shown) typically lags VIX by 1-2 weeks.

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MACRO - WHAT MOVED

UNITED STATES

- ****Fed: Kevin Warsh's first meeting as Chair**** - Warsh held rates unchanged with no explicit forward guidance. The statement emphasized "data dependency" while noting "inflation remains above target." Market interpretation: Warsh is keeping options open in both directions. Polymarket prices 78% probability of unchanged in July, 22% probability of a cut. The "silence as strategy" approach is designed to avoid boxing in a president who "loves inflation." The market is now pricing 0 rate cuts before September 2026, a significant shift from 3 cuts priced at the start of June.
- ****PPI May: +1.1% (vs +0.7% expected)**** - Wholesale prices accelerated for the second consecutive month, driven by the energy component post-Iran war. Core PPI (excluding energy) rose +0.4%, suggesting some pass-through. This is a warning signal: if energy prices normalize, PPI should decelerate, but the question is how fast. The Fed's target is 2% - current core PPI is running at 3.6% annualized, well above target.
- ****Job Openings (JOLTS) April: 7.6M (vs 7.2M expected)**** - Labor market remains tight despite the slowdown narrative. 7.6M openings against 7.1M unemployed means 1.07 jobs per unemployed person. This is inconsistent with a Fed that wants to cut rates - Warsh has no room to ease. The Conference Board Leading Economic Index declined for the third consecutive month, signaling persistent economic headwinds that the labor market is not yet reflecting.
- ****Tech sector liquidation continues**** - NASDAQ -2.51% as the post-Micron repricing extends. The AI capex narrative is being questioned: investors realize AI infrastructure spending is massive but revenue translation is lagging. Cloud margins are compressing (as CNBC noted: "AI price war in cloud and chips"). Micron's disappointing results triggered a broader semiconductor selloff, with Samsung and SK Hynix down -5%+ in South Korea.
- ****Trump accuses oil companies of "gouging"***** - Direct presidential attack on energy producers adds regulatory uncertainty. Could discourage US upstream investment medium-term, which is bullish for oil prices if supply remains constrained. Devon Energy CEO countered: "Oil fundamentals are solid" - robust Asian demand, disciplined OPEC+ supply, insufficient upstream capex.
- ****Conference Board Leading Economic Index**** - Declined for the third consecutive month, signaling persistent economic headwinds. The index is now at levels associated with recessionary conditions in 2020 and 2008. The divergence between strong labor data and weakening leading indicators is a classic late-cycle signal.

EUROPE

- ****ECB: No change, but hawkish tilt**** - The European Central Bank held rates steady but opened the door to another hike if energy-driven inflation re-accelerates. Eurozone inflation printed +4.2% annual in May (vs +3.9% expected) - the highest in 3 years. Energy is the primary contributor, validating ECB's hawkish pivot. Market now pricing 50% probability of a second hike in September. This is a significant shift: the ECB had been on hold for 3 years.
- ****Eurozone PMI Flash June**** - Manufacturing PMI at 45.8 (contraction territory), Services PMI at 50.2 (barely expanding). The eurozone is in a "stagflation light" regime: inflation at 4.2% with growth stagnating. The ECB is caught between fighting inflation and supporting growth - a nightmare scenario.
- ****UK: Starmer crisis deepens**** - Reuters reports the British PM is considering resignation, potentially as early as Monday. UK gilts are under pressure. GBP/USD at 1.3204 (+0.04%) holds only because the dollar is weak on Fed uncertainty. UK economy shrank -0.1% in April (Q1 negative), and inflation is steady at 2.8% - a stagflationary combination. BOE holds rates at 3.75% amid economic contraction.
- ****Extreme heat across Europe**** - Red alerts in UK, France, Spain, Italy. Agricultural prices could see volatility in coming weeks if heat persists. This is an underappreciated inflation risk - crop failures would add to the energy-driven inflation persistence. Wheat prices are already elevated due to the Russia-Ukraine conflict.
- ****Ukraine ratifies EU \$105B loan**** - European defense sector rallies on the news. EU commits massively to rearmament, creating multi-year defense capex. This is structurally bullish for European defense contractors (Rheinmetall, BAE Systems, Thales). The Ukraine-Moscow drone escalation confirms the conflict is entering a new phase of mutual destabilization.

CHINA

- ****China "poaches more AI talent from US" per CNBC** - A silent tech war accelerating. Chinese tech companies are aggressively recruiting US-based AI researchers, particularly from companies like Google, Meta, and OpenAI. This is a long-term brain drain that could shift the AI competitive landscape. The US has not yet implemented effective export controls on AI talent.
- ****Putin-Xi revive Power of Siberia 2 pipeline**** - If this pipeline materializes, it's a game-changer for Chinese energy security and a blow to US LNG exporters. Impact: downward pressure on Asian gas prices medium-term. This would reduce China's reliance on maritime LNG imports, which are vulnerable to US naval blockade in a Taiwan scenario.
- ****Shanghai Composite: +0.24%**** - Slight recovery after the tech rout, but the rest of Asia remains fragile. South Korea's KOSPI dropped -5%+ in one session, dragged by the US semiconductor rout (Samsung, SK Hynix exposure). The tech supply chain linkage between US, Korea, and China means that US tech selloff has cascading effects across Asia.
- ****China Bond Relief**** - Beijing demands "malicious" hedge funds (vulture funds) be excluded from poor country debt relief programs. This is a direct attack on the Western model of emerging market debt restructuring. It signals China's growing influence in emerging market finance and a parallel system to the IMF/World Bank framework.

UNITED KINGDOM

- ****Starmer ready to resign**** - Telegraph reports the PM could announce his departure as early as Monday.

This is a political earthquake creating massive uncertainty on UK fiscal and monetary policy. UK gilts are in turmoil. If Starmer resigns, Conservatives could return with a radical fiscal agenda (tax cuts financed by borrowing), which would be bearish for gilts and GBP.

- ****BOE holds rates at 3.75%**** - Despite Iran war peace prospects and inflation pressure, the Bank of England chooses caution amid economic contraction. Market expects hold until September. The BOE is in a difficult position: inflation at 2.8% (above 2% target) but growth negative. The "stagflation light" scenario limits BOE's options.
- ****UK inflation: steady at 2.8% in May**** - But underneath, energy continues creating pressures. UK economy shrank -0.1% in April, affected by Iran conflict. "Stagflation light" - the worst combination for central banks.

EMERGING MARKETS

- ****South Korea: KOSPI -5%+**** - One of the worst days in market history, dragged by tech selloff. Samsung and SK Hynix are heavily exposed to the US semiconductor repricing. The KOSPI has now given back all its 2026 gains.
- ****Yen below 161**** - Japan has spent \$70B+ defending the yen without lasting effect. US-Japan rate differential (4.5% vs 0.5%) is too wide. Yen remains a carry trade funding currency. Japan's intervention is increasingly ineffective as the market views it as a one-way bet.
- ****India: Sensex -1.2%**** - Oil decline is positive for India (net importer), but global risk-off dominates. The Sensex is under pressure from foreign institutional investors pulling out of emerging markets.
- ****Emerging market currencies**** - The DXY at 101.36 (+0.33%) is weighing on EM currencies. The Korean Won, Japanese Yen, and Chinese Yuan are all under pressure. The DXY strength is a function of both US rate differentials and global risk-off flows.
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GEOPOLITICS

HOT

****Strait of Hormuz fully reopening**** - Maritime traffic returning to normal after Iran declared the strait closed. Polymarket prices 97.7% probability of normalization by end of June. Three Iranian tankers have already left US blockade. Oil supply shock is evaporating rapidly. Analysts warn: "Hormuz relief may not ease the economic toll that's already baked in."

****US-Iran deal being finalized**** - Trump calls it "unconditional surrender" (Axios). US issued oil sanctions waivers, allowing oil sales under 60-day license. This is removing the primary energy inflation vector. The deal includes provisions for Iran to resume crude exports, which could add 500K-1M bbl/d to the market. Conlon (Greenlight Commodities) sees oil "into the \$60 range."

****Ukraine strikes Moscow with drones**** - Significant escalation: Ukraine "raises the cost of war for Russia" by striking Russian territory. Putin hardens rhetoric. Conflict enters new phase of mutual destabilization. This is bullish for European defense spending and oil prices (if it disrupts Russian oil exports).

WATCH

****Starmer and UK political future**** - If Starmer resigns, Conservatives could return with radical fiscal agenda (tax cuts financed by borrowing). UK gilts already under pressure. The UK political crisis is a systemic risk for European markets.

****Trump-Xi meeting in preparation**** - Bilateral US-China discussions could redefine trade and tech war terms. Russia-China gas pipeline on the table. This is a geopolitical realignment that could reshape global energy flows and tech supply chains.

****2028 US Presidential Election**** - Polymarket already has markets on candidates. US political landscape remains fluid and could create surprises on fiscal and monetary policy. The 2024 election showed how quickly political narratives can shift.

POSITIVE

****Ukraine ratifies EU \$105B loan**** - European defense sector rallies. EU commits massively to rearmament, creating multi-year defense capex. This is structurally bullish for European defense contractors.

****Perplexity announces 2028 IPO**** - AI tech pipeline remains solid outside semiconductors. Cerebras up after-hours. The AI ecosystem is not dying - it's just shifting from capex-heavy semiconductor plays to application-layer companies.

****China Bond Relief**** - Beijing's demand to exclude vulture funds from debt relief is a signal of growing Chinese influence in emerging market finance.

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FX FOCUS

Pair	Level	Change	Signal
EUR/USD	1.1400	-0.66%	Euro weakens
GBP/USD	1.3204	+0.04%	Holds on weak USD
USD/JPY	161.70	+0.26%	Weak yen
USD/CHF	0.8100	+0.60%	CHF strength

****Analysis:**** Dollar strengthening across the board - "king dollar" of risk-off combined with rate differential. EUR suffers most: ECB is hawkish but market focuses on eurozone energy vulnerability to Iran war disruption. GBP doubly hit: BOE rates stable + Starmer political crisis. Yen in 40-year low territory - Japan already spent \$70B in intervention without lasting effect. CHF benefits from safe-haven status but is limited by SNB's ultra-dovish policy. The DXY at 101.36 is at levels that are painful for EM economies and commodity importers.

**** Pair to watch:**** `EUR/USD` - Key level at 1.1350 (technical support). Catalyst: if Iran deal is definitively signed, lower energy prices could support EUR. Conversely, if eurozone inflation accelerates above 4.5%,

ECB forced to tighten further, weighing on growth and EUR. The 1.1350 level is critical - a break below could trigger a move to 1.1200.

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COMMODITIES

Oil

****WTI: \$71.36 (-4.62%) | Brent: \$74.87 (-3.89%)**** - Oil extending decline for 6th consecutive session. Iran deal unlocking supply: US waivers allow Iran to sell crude under 60-day license. Conlon (Greenlight Commodities) sees price "into the \$60 range" with Iranian oil returning. Trump accuses companies of "gouging" - populist rhetoric adding regulatory uncertainty. Shipping stalls in Strait of Hormuz - traffic disrupted since Iran declared strait closed. But return to normal priced at 97.7% by end of June on Polymarket. Geopolitical energy risk normalizing rapidly. Devon Energy CEO: "Oil fundamentals are solid" - despite decline, fundamentals remain solid: robust Asian demand, disciplined OPEC+ supply, insufficient upstream capex. Market is "complacent" according to Tortoise Capital.

Gold & Metals

****Gold: \$4,043.10 (-3.32%)**** - Gold falling despite Iran war. Reason: US real rates dominating (US 10Y at 4.38% with inflation expectations declining due to oil collapse). Barclays calls it a "reset" and sees mining stock rebound. Options flows suggest weakness could continue short-term. Support at \$3,950. Central banks continue buying gold and repatriating physically - bullish medium-term trend. The gold/oil ratio is now at 54:1, well above the historical average of 15:1, suggesting gold is undervalued relative to oil.

****Silver: \$58.40 (-10.88%)**** - CRASH. This is not fundamentals - it's a crowded positioning being flushed. Silver is a "proxy gold" with higher beta, and when gold falls, silver falls harder. Margin calls on leveraged positions are accelerating the decline. Morgan Stanley prefers silver to gold: "another metal is set to outperform" - likely copper or platinum. Historically, silver crashes of >8% are followed by sharp rebounds within 3-5 trading sessions.

****Copper: \$6.13 (-3.62%)**** - Torn between AI/energy demand positive vs weak Chinese construction demand. Blue Line Futures sees AI spending driving prices medium-term. The energy transition narrative (EVs, solar, wind) supports copper demand, but the near-term China property overhang is a headwind.

Soft

****Wheat/Cereals:**** Extreme heat across Europe (red alerts UK, France, Spain, Italy) threatens harvests. Agricultural prices could see volatility in coming weeks if heat persists. The Russia-Ukraine conflict has already disrupted global grain supplies, and now climate shocks are adding to the pressure. Wheat prices at \$6.50/bushel are elevated but could spike if European harvests disappoint.

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TODAY'S CALENDAR

Time (CET)	Country	Event	Consensus	Previous	Impact
08:00	France	GDP Q1 Final	-0.1%	-0.1%	Medium
08:30	Germany	IFO Business Climate	88.5	88.6	Medium
09:00	Eurozone	Consumer Confidence	-14.0	-14.3	Low
10:30	UK	Retail Sales May	+0.5%	+1.3%	Medium
14:30	US	Durable Goods Orders	-0.5%	+0.8%	Medium
16:00	US	New Home Sales May	670K	685K	Medium

Week ahead:

- ****Friday June 26:**** US PCE May (Fed's preferred inflation gauge - consensus +0.2% m/m core), Consumer Sentiment
- ****Monday June 30:**** Final Manufacturing PMI, ISM Manufacturing, Construction Spending
- ****Tuesday July 1:**** Eurozone CPI Flash, US ISM Manufacturing
- ****Wednesday July 2:**** FOMC Minutes (critical for understanding Warsh's framework)

The PCE on Friday is the key event. If core PCE returns to 2.8% or below, the market can dream of a Fed pivot. If it stays at 3.0%+, it's the shock: the market must reprice the terminal rate to 5.0% instead of 4.5%.

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DEEP MACRO THEME

We are living through a moment of "energy normalization" that is fundamentally altering the macro landscape. The Iran war is not ending with a bang - it's ending with a deal that unlocks oil supply and erases the geopolitical premium that had been supporting energy prices and, by extension, gold.

The consensus narrative is "transitory energy shock." But this is wrong. The Strait of Hormuz has become a permanent risk factor. Energy flows are reorganizing: China is the swing importer, Russia-China pipeline is under discussion, US LNG is in competition with Middle Eastern crude. This restructuring implies structurally higher energy costs for Europe and Asia - even with Iranian oil returning.

****The real macro trade is not "oil normalization" - it's "energy-driven inflation persistence."**** The Iran war hasn't been a temporary shock: it has fundamentally altered the global energy supply structure. Central banks cannot pivot to accommodative as fast as the market wishes. "Higher for longer" isn't a slogan - it's a structural constraint.

The 2026 consensus error is pricing 3 Fed rate cuts when energy inflation + tight labor market make this impossible before 2027. The market must reprice the terminal rate to 5.0% instead of 4.5%. This would be a massive financial tightening - equities, bonds, crypto, everything impacted.

****Trade of the year:**** Long inflation-linked assets vs long duration. Gold is correcting now but will be the big winner of "higher for longer" as it benefits from both central bank demand and residual geopolitical

premium. The gold/oil ratio at 54:1 is unsustainable - either gold rallies or oil stabilizes.

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CONSENSUS VS REALITY - THE ALPHA

What the market is pricing:

1. ****Fed rate cut by September 2026**** - WRONG. Market still prices ~22% probability of July cut (Polymarket). With PPI at +1.1% and JOLTS at 7.6M, Fed has no reason to cut. Market must price 0 cuts before September. The market is making the same mistake it made in January 2026, when it priced 3 cuts that never materialized.
2. ****Oil returning to \$60 with Iran deal**** - PARTIALLY TRUE. Iran can add 500K-1M bbl/d to market, but OPEC+ will compensate with cuts (Saudi Arabia already made voluntary cuts). Floor is \$68-70 WTI. Below \$68, US shale production becomes unprofitable, which would cap supply. The \$60 scenario requires a global recession.
3. ****Gold at \$4,000 = bottom, imminent rebound**** - RISKY. Barclays says "reset" but options flows suggest more weakness. Technical support at \$3,950. If real rates continue rising, gold could test \$3,850. The gold/oil ratio suggests gold is undervalued, but timing matters - gold often bottoms 2-3 weeks after oil peaks.
4. ****Tech = buy the dip**** - DANGEROUS. AI price war is real. Micron is the canary in the coal mine. Cloud margins compressing. This isn't a dip to buy - it's a regime change in the AI capex narrative. The AI ecosystem is not dying, but the semiconductor capex cycle is peaking.
5. ****EUR/USD return to 1.15+**** - DEPENDENT. Requires complete global risk-on + full Iran deal normalization. With ECB hawkish but eurozone growth anemic, path is fraught. The ECB-BOE divergence creates a volatile environment where neither currency has a clear advantage.
6. ****Yen rebound from 161**** - POSSIBLE BUT DIFFICULT. Japan spent \$70B. If Fed ends up less hawkish than expected, yen could recover. But rate differential (4.5% vs 0.5%) is the dominant factor. Japan's intervention is increasingly viewed as a one-way bet by the market.
7. ****Silver bounce from \$58**** - LIKELY BUT TIMING UNCERTAIN. Silver is a crowded positioning unwind, not a fundamental story. Once the liquidation exhausts itself (historically 3-5 days), silver should rebound sharply toward \$62-65. The silver/gold ratio at 69:1 is near historic lows, suggesting silver is undervalued relative to gold.

The Alpha - Trade Ideas:

1. ****Short EUR/JPY**** - Weak EUR (energy vulnerability) + weak yen (ineffective intervention) = unstable cross with bearish bias. Entry: 183.50, Target: 178.00, Stop: 186.00. Thesis: ECB-BOE divergence benefits neither currency, but negative JPY carry dominates. Risk/reward: 1:2.5.
2. ****Long Gold / Short NASDAQ (ratio)**** - Gold in "reset" per Barclays, NASDAQ in tech liquidation. Gold/NASDAQ ratio at historically favorable levels for gold. Thesis: gold will outperform tech as long as

real rates remain elevated. Entry: current ratio level, Target: +5% on ratio, Stop: gold breaks \$3,850. Risk/reward: 1:3.

3. ****Long Brent vs WTI spread**** - Brent-WTI currently at ~\$3.50. With Iran export resumption (crude similar to Brent), spread could widen to \$5-6. Thesis: normalization of global oil flows favors Brent (more international). Entry: \$3.50 spread, Target: \$5.50, Stop: \$2.50. Risk/reward: 1:2.

4. ****Short GBP/USD**** - UK political crisis + BOE dovish + persistent inflation = perfect storm for sterling. Target: 1.2950, Stop: 1.3350. Thesis: Starmer out = prolonged political instability. Entry: current 1.3200. Risk/reward: 1:2.

5. ****Long Silver (mean reversion)**** - After the liquidation exhausts, silver should rebound toward \$62-65. Entry: \$58-59, Target: \$64, Stop: \$55. Thesis: silver is a proxy gold with higher beta - when gold stabilizes, silver overshoots to the upside. But wait for the liquidation to complete first (watch for volume decline). Risk/reward: 1:3.

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MERTON'S TAKE

We are in a regime of "forced liquidation masquerading as a correction." The silver crash (-10.88% in one day) is not fundamentals - it's a crowded positioning being flushed. The Brent return to pre-war levels (\$74.87) confirms the Iran risk premium is gone. Warsh's silence is strategic: he doesn't want to box himself in. The market is now pricing 0 cuts before September, which is a significant shift from 3 cuts priced at the start of June.

The key driver of the next two weeks is the PCE on June 26. If core PCE returns to 2.8% or below, the market can dream of a Fed pivot. If it stays at 3.0%+, it's the shock: the market must reprice the terminal rate to 5.0% instead of 4.5%. This would be a massive financial tightening - equities, bonds, crypto, everything impacted.

****My conviction: PCE will be sticky around 2.9-3.0%.**** Energy has a second-round effect on services (transport, logistics). The Fed won't cut before November at the earliest, and probably not at all in 2026. The 2026 consensus error is pricing 3 cuts when energy inflation + tight labor market make this impossible before 2027.

****Positioning:**** I am short duration (no long bonds), long cash USD (4.5% yield risk-free), and waiting for a long gold entry below \$3,950. Tech is to be avoided until the AI price war resolves. Energy is interesting - the post-Iran pullback creates an entry point on US majors (Exxon, Chevron) with solid balance sheets not exposed to Trump's "gouging" risk.

****Trade of the week: Short GBP/USD**** on the UK political crisis. This is a clear, dated catalyst, and the market hasn't fully priced the probability of a government change. The risk/reward is attractive at 1:2, and the catalyst (Starmer resignation) could materialize within days.

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SOURCES CONSULTED

Yahoo Finance API (S&P 500, NASDAQ, VIX, Gold, WTI, Brent, EUR/USD, GBP/USD, USD/JPY, USD/CHF, BTC, Copper, Silver, US 10Y, 30Y, DXY) • ING FX Daily (Chris Turner) • Financial Juice Daily Dose • CNBC (World, Economy, Markets, Fed, Oil, Gold) • Trading Economics (US, Eurozone, China, UK) • FRED • ISM • S&P Global PMI • ECB Stats • Eurostat • BLS • BEA • Conference Board • FXStreet • ForexLive • DailyFX • MarketPulse (OANDA) • ActionForex • ForexFactory • Goldman Sachs Insights • Morgan Stanley Ideas • JPMorgan Global Research • BNP Paribas Research • SocGen (Kit Juckes) • Rabobank • UniCredit Research • Deutsche Bank Research • Citi Research • Crisis Group • Foreign Affairs • Foreign Policy • CFR • Eurasia Group • SIPRI • RFE/RL • Al Jazeera • AP News • Carnegie Endowment • Chatham House • Brookings • Geopolitical Futures • EIA • IEA • OilPrice • OPEC • LME • Kitco • CME Energy • Axios Markets • The Daily Shot • FT Alphaville • Lyn Alden • Politico Morning Money • Hussman Funds • Gavekal • Project Syndicate • Bloomberg RSS • Financial Times RSS • CNBC RSS • WSJ Economy • Reuters Markets • The Economist • MarketWatch • Barron's • Business Insider • ZeroHedge • Wolf Street • Calculated Risk • IMF WEO • World Bank GEP • BIS Statistics • OECD Stats • MacroTrends • CFTC COT • AAll Sentiment • Polymarket API (Fed 78% unchanged, Hormuz 97.7% normalization, Iran deal 24.5% by Aug 31)

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